spawns again and the cycle continues. To rectify this, you need to first switch to Single user mode.

In Single User Mode, reboot your machine, and on the Grub screen, choose the Linux OS and hit [E]. This will take you to the next screen that shows boot parameters, specifically three lines that control the booting of your machine. Move the cursor to the line containing **"kernel"**, and again hit [E] to edit that line. At the end of the line, give a space, type in **"single"**, and hit [**Enter**]. You will be taken back to the previous screen. Now press [**B**] to boot with the new parameter. The OS will boot to text mode. Now, follow the steps listed below:

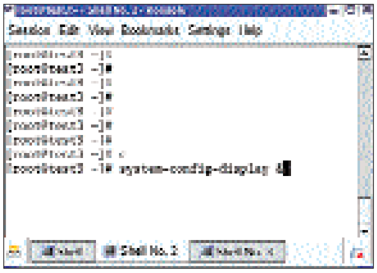
#touch 0 > /[$home]/.Xclients

To clear the contents of the file.

#cd /[$home]/[$user]

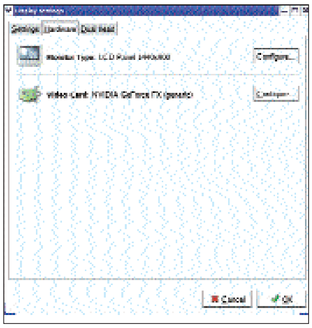
#cp .Xclients-default.orig .Xclients-default. This will restore **.Xclients-default** to its original settings.

#cp xorg.conf. backup xorg.conf. This will restore Xorg to its earlier state.



"system-config-" is a set of commands that can be used to modify certain device settings

After restoring all the files, switch to run level 3



The "system-config-display" command opens Display Settings

(the text mode of the operating system):

#init 3 + [**Enter**]

Log in as root and then try **"system-config-display"**. Check the settings. If all is OK, boot, then switch back to the graphics mode either using the **"startx"** command or **"init 5"**. (Init 5 is the graphics mode of the Linux operating system.)

Single user mode is an important tool for trouble shooting certain problems. If problems cannot be resolved from this mode, the Rescue CD is another option. Keep single user mode in mind... it is very useful!

Browser Problems

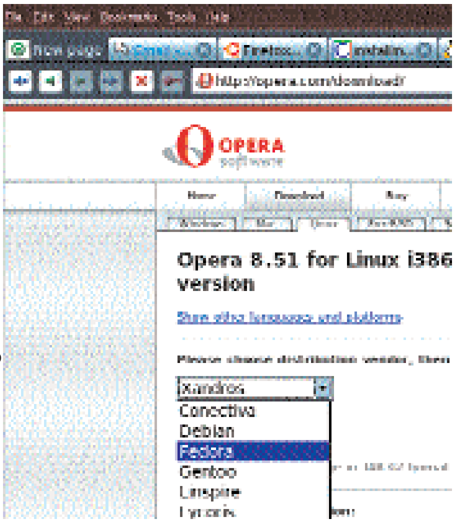
Browser related problems are common to those using older versions of Linux distros. You are often reminded by Web sites such as Gmail to upgrade to a newer browser—so let's do it! Most Linux systems either come with the Mozilla browser or an old version of Mozilla Firefox. Here, we'll upgrade the older Mozilla to the new Firefox 1.5. We shall also take a look at Opera 8.5 and demonstrate that it works just like its Windows counterpart.

At **www.mozilla .com/firefox**, you'll see the download link for the Linux version for Firefox. Download the 8 MB compressed archive. Once the download is complete, extract the files to a folder in **/usr**. In our example, we shall extract the files to **/usr/more-apps**. To do this, use the following commands listed in *Commands Box 1*.

Commands Box 1

Making a directory called "more-apps" under /usr	$cd /usr $sudo mkdir more-apps
Extracting the files to the new directory	$su root#tar -C /usr/more-apps -zxvf firefox-1.5.0.1.tar.gz

You will not find any installer packages like RPM or DEB in the extracted folder; instead, you will find a few source object files (*.so) and some folders. Actually, there *is no installer*: all you need to do is to create symbolic links to your current plug-ins. It is better to switch to root user than using **sudo** all the time. Sudo will be necessary for Ubuntu users, but they can choose to open a root terminal instead of the normal Gnome terminal.



Choose the appropriate Opera package

Whenever you click on the Firefox button or type "firefox" at the command line, the old version of the browser pops up. So to ensure that only the new Firefox opens, you need to change the symbolic link that relates to the action of opening the browser. Use the **"which"** command to figure out the path to Firefox. Change your directory to the directory where Firefox is located. Rename the old Firefox from "firefox" to "firefox.old". (Command Box 2)

Commands Box 2

Setting Firefox to run the new Firefox 1.5	#which firefox(output: /usr/bin/firefox)#cd /usr/bin#mv firefox firefox.old#ln -s /usr/more-apps/firefox/firefox

Now click on the button that opens Firefox or just use the command line. In the browser that opens, click on **Help > About Mozilla Firefox**. This should show you "Firefox version 1.5.0.1".

Opera 8.5 is very easy to install, but new users generally manage to just install it and can't proceed thereafter.
Download the latest Opera browser from **http://opera. com/download/**

Choose the right package from the list available. Opera is compiled as an installer package for all versions of Linux. We downloaded it for Fedora Core 3. To install it, just run the command for installation, which is **"dpkg -i"** for Debian users and **"rpm -ivh"** for distros following the RedHat Package Manager. Issue the following command to install Opera on RPM systems:

#rmp -ivh opera-8.51-20051114.5-shared-qt.i386-en.rpm + [**Enter**]

The installation process completes in just a few seconds. Most beginners get stuck at this point not knowing how to proceed, because the installer doesn't create any shortcuts on the desktop or in the program menu. That's because one step remains. Type in **"opera &"** at the shell prompt and hit [**Enter**]. A window will pop up stating **"detected KDE running..."**; this finalises the installation process. After this is complete, you will find shortcuts for Opera in the program menu.

Adding extensions, add-ons, themes or skin is a piece of cake after you have the